

► **NEAR THE BUSTLING lanes of the Siddhivinayak Temple at Prabhadevi in Mumbai stands a four-storey building that was earlier known as Tata Press. Today, it hosts the buzzing headquarters of ICICI Lombard General Insurance. On its top floor sits its MD & CEO, Bhargav Dasgupta, one of the longest-serving CEOs in the general insurance industry, who has now been in the insurer's corner room for almost 14 years.**

The 56-year-old management graduate from IIM Bangalore took over the reins of the insurer in 2009, but his association with the group goes back to 1992 when he joined ICICI Bank as a Senior General Manager, and then worked in various roles across the group, including as Executive Director in ICICI Prudential Life Insurance. If familiarity gives comfort, then Dasgupta certainly makes one feel at ease with his simplicity and demeanour. His easy approach is reflected in the recent merger of Bharti AXA General Insurance with ICICI Lombard, which became seamlessly effective within days of getting the final approval from regulator Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) in September 2021. After the merger, ICICI Lombard has become the second largest general insurer (on gross direct premium underwritten) with 8.71 per cent market share (till November 2022) after state-owned The New India Assurance (13.63 per cent).

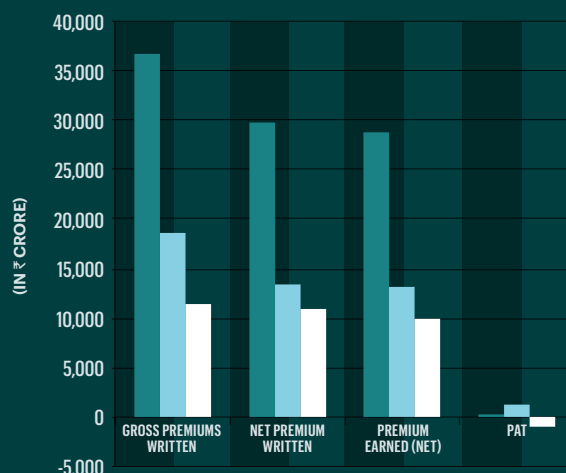
But the hawk-eyed leader of ICICI Lombard—which had a market cap of ₹61,095 crore on December 27—knows that he can't rest on his laurels. Although the merger has helped the insurer jump three positions, leaving behind one of its closest competitors, Bajaj Allianz General Insurance, its next challenge is to drive organic growth and also keep competitors at bay.

On the cut-throat competition in the sector, Tapan Singhel, MD & CEO of Bajaj Allianz General Insurance, says, "Acquiring is a different ball game. My belief is to build a solid culture through organic growth. I am not ruling out inorganic growth, but to acquire just to become No. 1 is not our philosophy. Our philosophy is to work really hard to build a 100-year system."

Moreover, while the merger of three public sector

THE BOTTOM LINE

ICICI Lombard recorded better PAT than its peers in FY22

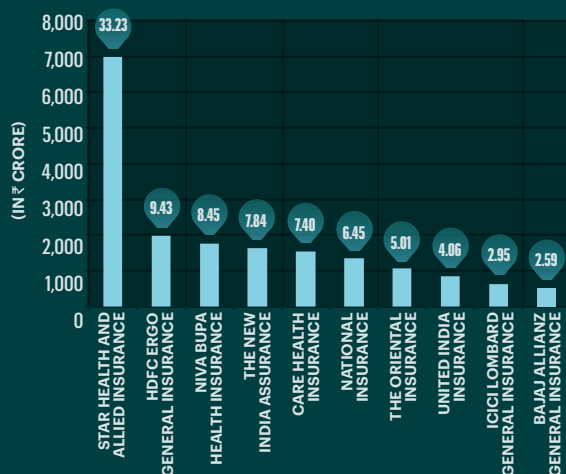


● THE NEW INDIA ASSURANCE ● ICICI LOMBARD
● STAR HEALTH AND ALLIED INSURANCE*

DATA FOR FY22; ONLY LISTED INSURERS ARE CONSIDERED
*STAR HEALTH IS A STANDALONE HEALTH INSURANCE COMPANY; NET PREMIUMS IS THE SUM OF PREMIUMS RECEIVED MINUS THE PREMIUMS CEDED TO REINSURANCE COMPANIES; EARNED PREMIUM IS THE PORTION OF A POLICY'S PREMIUM THAT IS RECORDED AS REVENUE; SOURCE BSE

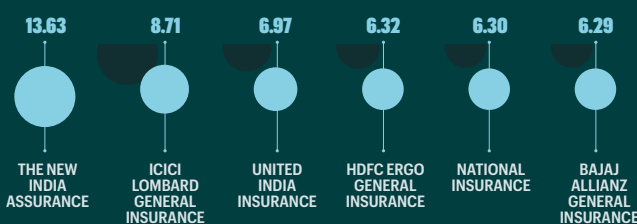
SCOPE FOR GROWTH

ICICI Lombard ranks at 9th position in terms of market share in the retail health insurance segment



● RETAIL HEALTH BUSINESS ● MARKET SHARE IN PER CENT
DATA AS OF NOVEMBER 2022; SOURCE GIC

BIG, AND GETTING BIGGER



DATA AS OF NOVEMBER 2022; MARKET SHARE (IN PER CENT) IS BASED ON